

want to switch to. For example, if you want to see what's in the Movies directory of your home directory, type `cd /Users/<User name>/Movies` and press [Enter]. The % prompt will show you what it considers to be the working directory. Now you can use the `ls` command to list the contents of your Movies directory.

You don't even need to type the entire path. You can just specify which directory you want to see relative to the directory you're already in. For example, if your Home folder is the working directory, the relative pathname of the Trailers directory would be `Movies/Trailers` and you need not use the absolute pathname.

Here are the different ways you could switch from `~/` (your home directory) to `~/Movies`:

- `cd /Users/chris/Movies`. It will work no matter what your working directory is.
- `cd ~/Movies`. This, too, is an absolute pathname like the previous option and you could type it from anywhere. It uses the `~` shorthand (which always means my home directory).
- `cd Movies`. This streamlined relative path if you're already in your home directory.

Note

There's another way to specify a directory that involves no typing at all: dragging the icon of the directory you want to specify from the Finder directly into the Terminal window.

9.1.4 . .

Type `cd . .` to go from your home directory to `/Users`. You can use the dot-dot shortcut repeatedly to climb multiple directories at once: `cd . ./ . .`, which means "switch the working directory to the directory two levels higher up." If you were in your Documents directory, `. ./ . .` will change the working directory to the Users directory.

9.1.5 Keystroke-Saving Features

By now, you might be thinking that clicking on icons in Finder would still be faster than doing all this typing. Here's when the typing shortcuts of the `tcsh` shell come in and make your life easier.

9.1.6 Tab completion

Just like you highlight a file in a Finder window by typing the first few characters of its name, the tab completion feature saves you a lot of time by instantly fleshing out the rest of the directory's name after you have typed the first couple of letters of the path you want. Type `cd /U` and then press